

PRELUDE TO A PHILOSOPHY OF THE FUTURE

BASED ON BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL BY FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE

A guide for the Free Spirit brave enough to leave the land of safety and dogmatism. We are casting off from the prejudices of the past to sail into the 'dangerous perhaps.'



SUPPOSING TRUTH IS A WOMAN— WHAT THEN?

Is there not ground for suspicion that all philosophers, insofar as they were dogmatists, have failed to understand women?

The gruesome earnestness and clumsy importunity with which philosophers have approached Truth have been inept. It has not won her heart.

Insight: All dogmatic philosophy—like Plato's invention of 'Pure Spirit' and the 'Good in Itself'—was merely a noble childishness and a mask.



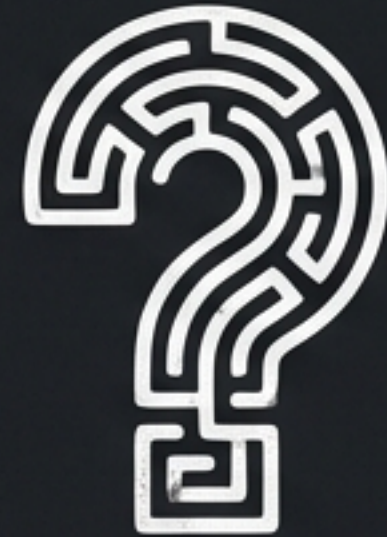
THE WILL TO TRUTH



**Why do we want truth?
Why not untruth?
Why not uncertainty?**

CONDITION OF LIFE: UNTRUTH

THE VALUE OF UNTRUTH



The falseness of a judgment is not necessarily an objection to a judgment.

False judgments—like logical fictions or synthetic judgments a priori—are often the most indispensable to us.

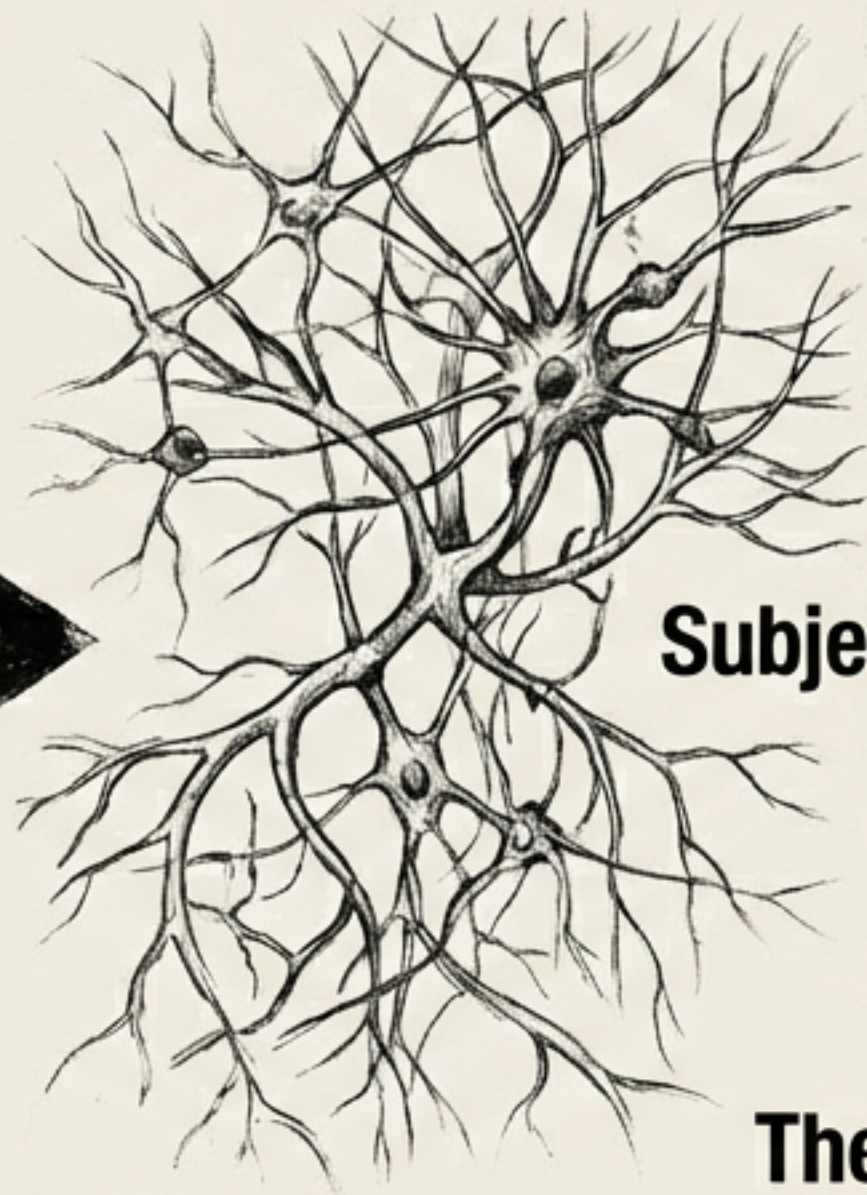
To renounce false judgments would be to renounce life.

THE SUPERSTITION OF THE 'I'

**The
Atomistic
Soul**



Subject-Multiplicity



The Error:

The belief in the 'soul atom'—something indestructible and indivisible.

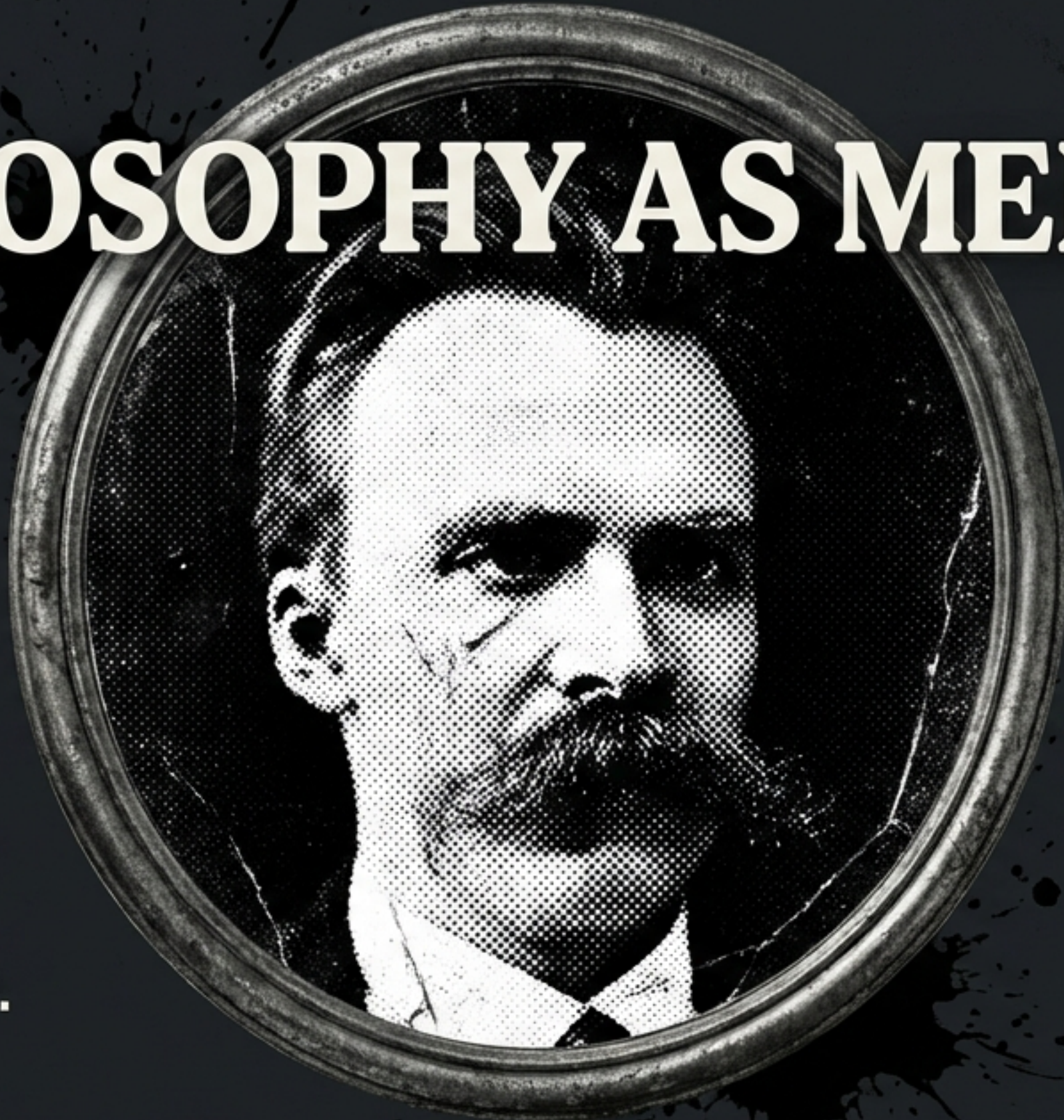
The Reality: A thought comes when 'it' wants, and not when 'I' want.

The Redefinition:

The soul is a social structure of drives and affects.

PHILOSOPHY AS MEMOIR

Gradually it has occurred to me what every great philosophy has been so far: namely the personal confession of its author and a kind of involuntary and unnoticed memoirs.



There is no purely 'objective knowledge-drive.' Moral (or immoral) intentions constitute the living seed from which the entire plant grows.

WILL TO POWER

An illustration of a gnarled tree trunk breaking through a large, rectangular stone block. The stone is cracked and crumbling, with several pieces flying off. The tree trunk is thick and textured, with roots visible. The background is a light beige color with some dark speckles.

THE FUNDAMENTAL DRIVE

Physiologists should think twice before positing the "drive for self-preservation" as the cardinal drive.

A living thing seeks above all to DISCHARGE its strength—life itself is WILL TO POWER.

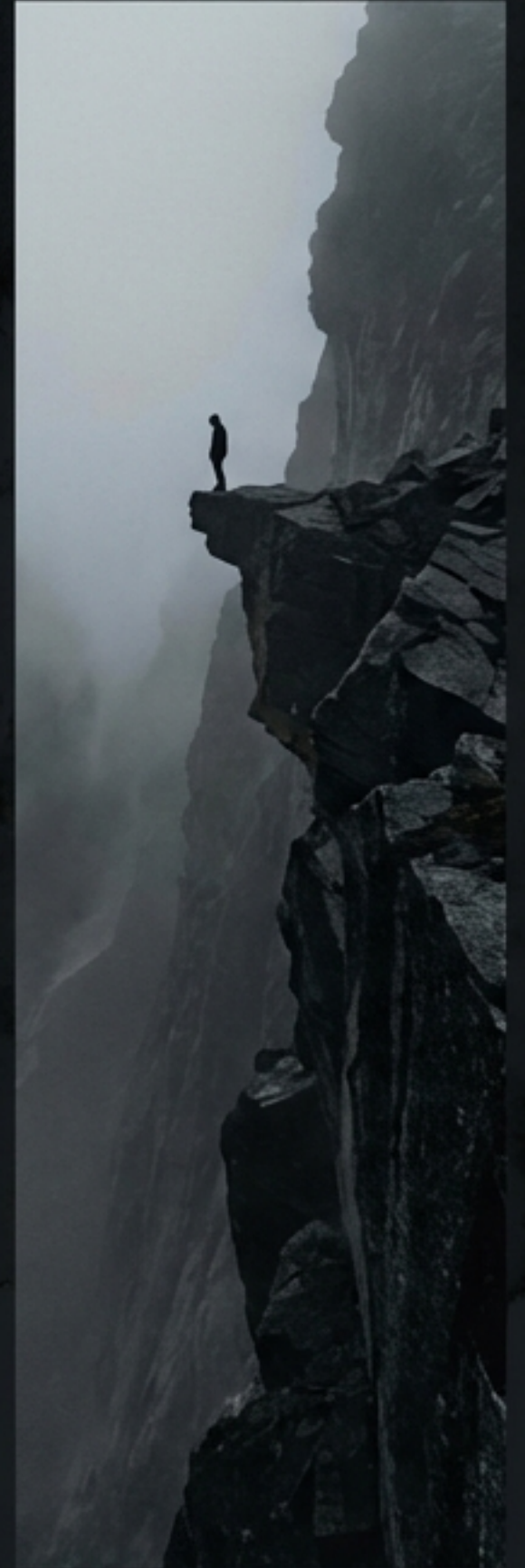
Self-preservation is only one of the indirect and most frequent consequences of this.

THE FREE SPIRIT

The Definition: One who has liberated themselves from the herd, tradition, and the need for a 'Yes' or 'No' from others.

The Risk: He enters into a labyrinth, he multiplies by a thousand the dangers that life already brings.

The Cost: No one witnesses how he gets lost or torn to pieces by the 'Minotaur of conscience.' He can no longer return to the compassion of humans.



EVERYTHING PROFOUND LOVES A MASK

Every profound spirit needs a mask: even more, a mask is continuously growing around every profound spirit.

Why? Because of the constantly false and shallow interpretations of every word and step they take.

The Result: The philosopher wanders around in the hearts and minds of his friends as a mask—and this is good.



THE LEVELERS



False Free Spirits. Eloquent slaves of democratic taste. Goal: Security, safety, comfort, and “equal rights.” They perceive suffering as something to be abolished.

THE FREE SPIRITS



The plant ‘man’ has grown strongest only under the reverse conditions—danger, severity, and the tension of the spirit.

**He who battles
monsters should take
care that he doesn't
become one in the
process.**

**And if you stare for a
long time into an
abyss, the abyss looks
into you, too.**

DANGEROUS TRUTHS

**Insanity is something
rare in individuals—but
in groups, parties,
peoples, and ages
it is the rule.**

**What is done out
of love always
happens beyond
good and evil.**

THE LADDER OF RELIGIOUS CRUELTY

Sacrifice of Human Beings

To the God. e.g., First-borns

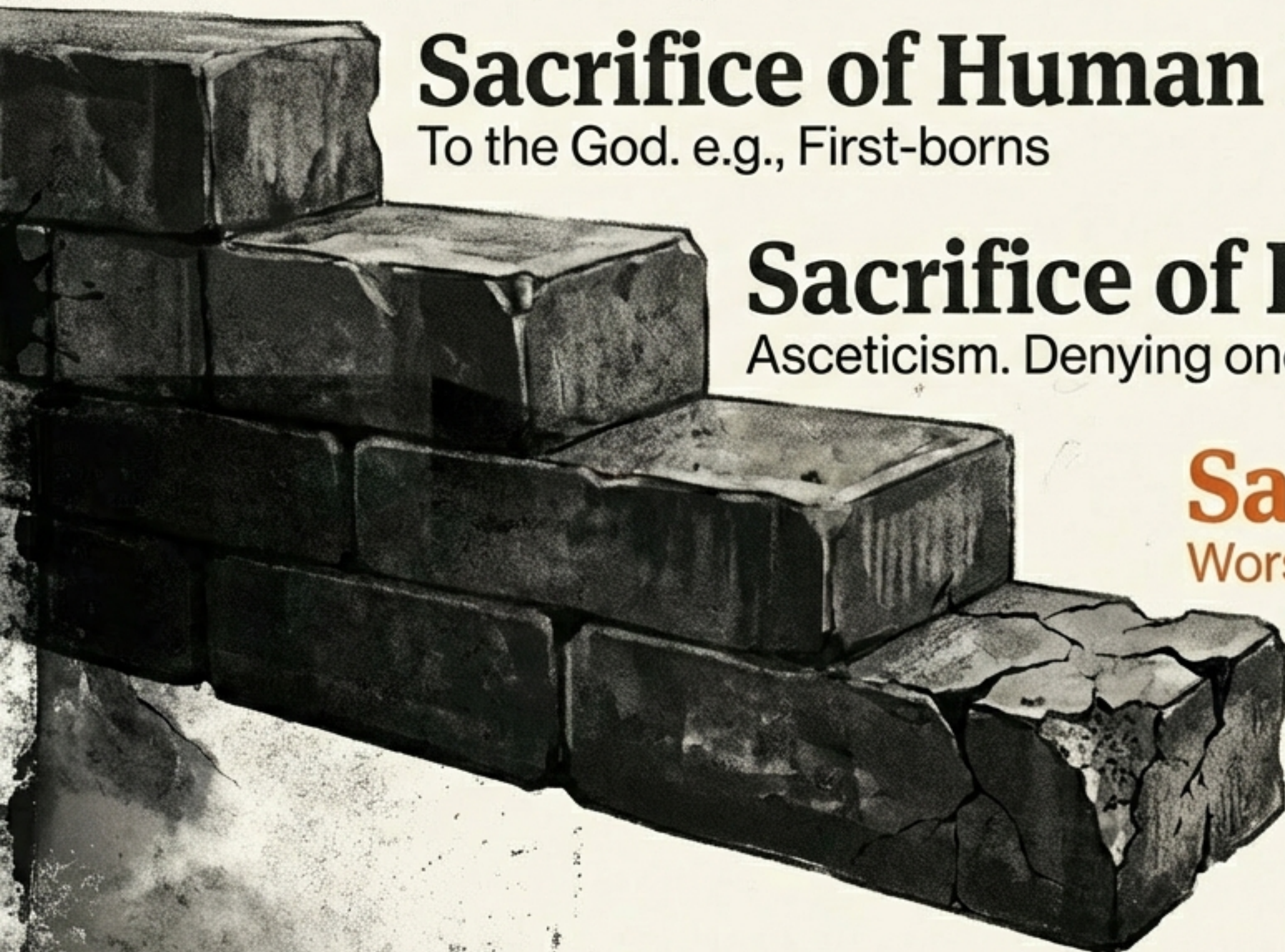
Sacrifice of Instincts

Asceticism. Denying one's nature

Sacrifice of God

Worshiping the Stone, Gravity, The Nothing

The paradoxical mystery of the ultimate cruelty reserved for the generation now emerging:
Sacrificing God himself for Nothingness.



FEAR IS THE MOTHER OF MORALITY



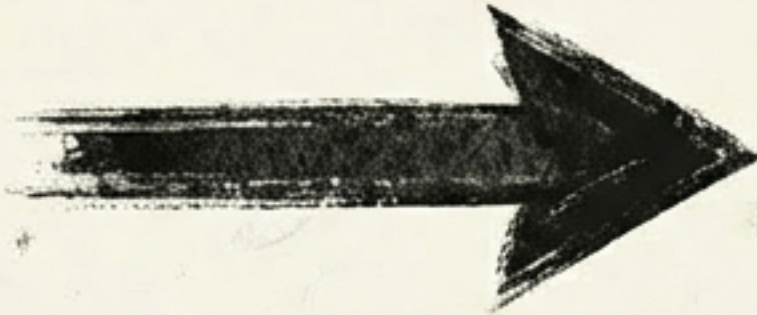
- Moral perspectives are shaped by what is dangerous to the community.
- When a society is safe from external enemies, the fear turns inward.
- Strong, dangerous drives (enterprising nature, lust to rule) are branded as immoral.
- The Herd Imperative: "We want that some day there should be nothing more to fear!"

THE SLAVE REVOLT IN MORALITY



Original Noble Values:
Powerful = Good.
Poor/Weak = Bad.

INVERSION



Jewish/Christian Inversion:
Poor/Weak = Good.
Powerful/Violent = Evil.

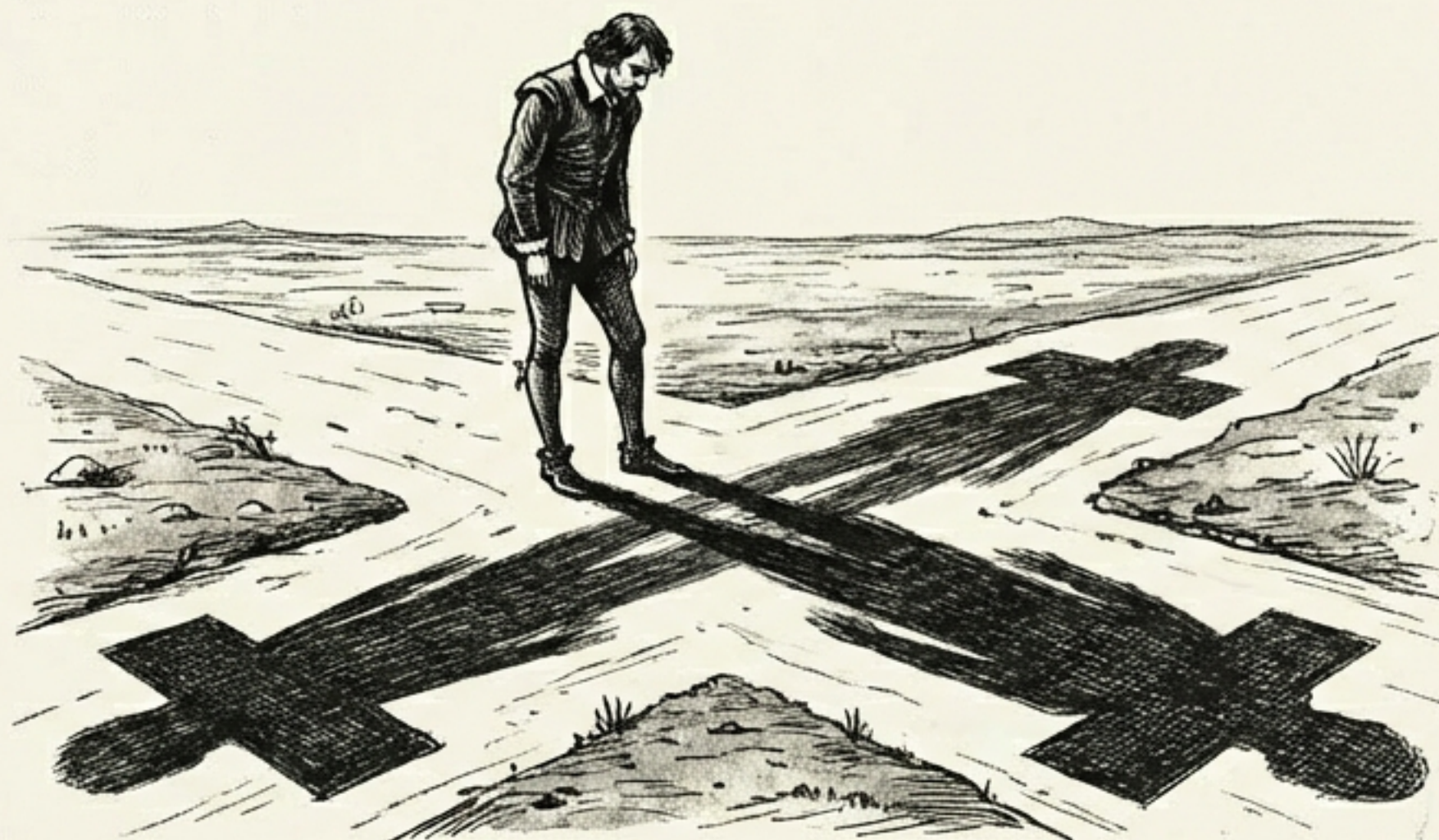
Significance: With them begins the slave revolt in morality, which has ruled Europe for two millennia.

THE SCHOLAR IS A MIRROR



The Objective Spirit is a costly, delicate tool. He accepts everything; he mirrors everything.
The Limit: He is not a goal, not a beginning, not a begetting. He is 'presque rien' (almost nothing).
Contrast: The genuine philosopher is not a spectator. He uses the scholar as a tool.

SKEPTICISM: PARALYSIS OF THE WILL



The Diagnosis: Skepticism is the most spiritual expression of a physiological weakness—sickliness of the will.

The Symptoms: Unrest, disruption, doubt. The 'No' and the 'Yes' are both perceived as bites.

The Cause: The radical mixing of classes and races in modern Europe.

THE PHILOSOPHERS OF THE FUTURE



Definition: They are commanders and legislators.

The Act: They do not just accept the past; they reach for the future with a creative hand.

The Decree: They say, 'Thus it SHALL be!'

The Formula: Their 'knowing' is creating, their creating is a legislation,
their will to truth is—WILL TO POWER.

THE ABYSMAL ANTAGONISM



The Insight: Woman is “more natural” than man—she has genuine predatory, cunning suppleness.

The Danger: The “emancipation of woman” is actually the weakening of woman—a defeminization.

Critique: By trying to compete on men’s terms, she unlearns her fear of man, but loses her most feminine instincts (power).

WE GOOD EUROPEANS



Critique: We are ‘Good Europeans,’ not caught up in the “atavistic attacks of fatherlandishness” (nationalism).

The Reality: The “historical sense” is our sixth sense—we are a chaos of instincts.

The Future: The time for petty politics is over. The next century brings the struggle for the dominion of the earth—the compulsion to GRAND POLITICS.

VIRTUES OF THE FREE SPIRIT

1. HONESTY

Not a clumsy “love of truth,” but a hardened, adventurous daring.

2. CRUELTY

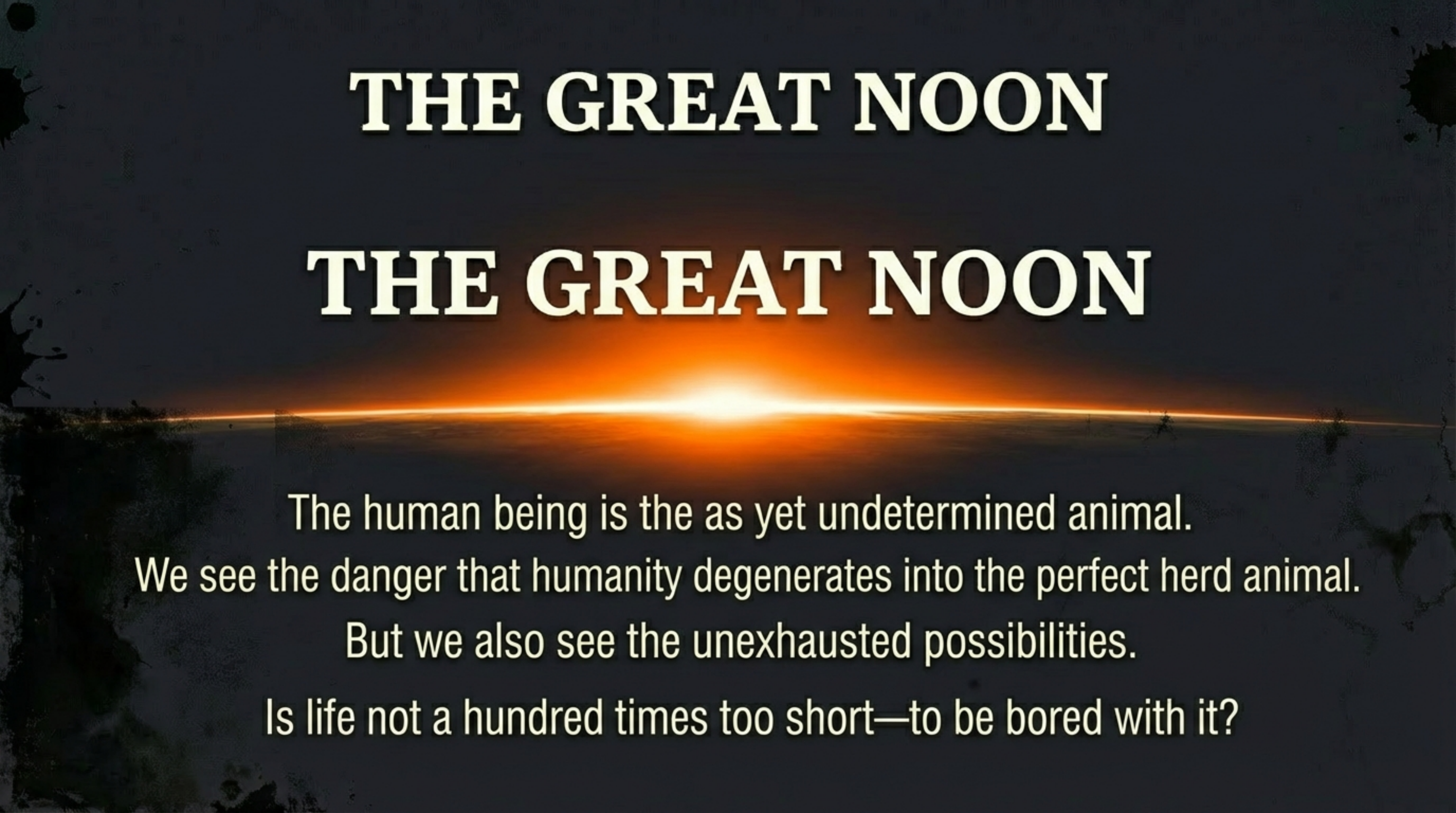
The ability to wield the knife against one’s own virtues and the “fundamental will of the spirit.”

3. SOLITUDE

The “Pathos of Distance.” The courage to stand alone.

4. BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL

The strength to rise above herd morality and create new values.



THE GREAT NOON

THE GREAT NOON

The human being is the as yet undetermined animal.

We see the danger that humanity degenerates into the perfect herd animal.

But we also see the unexhausted possibilities.

Is life not a hundred times too short—to be bored with it?